

Michael Pritz

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Bridging design and systems thinking to build user-centered, technically robust library services.

EXPERIENCE

National Aeronautics and Space Administration (NASA)

Langley Research Center

Librarian (GS-13)

2018-2026

Hampton, VA

Served as lead systems librarian for NASA Libraries, led enterprise print and digital design projects, and managed research and archival collections at Langley to improve access to technical, historic, and audiovisual resources for NASA scientists, engineers, and mission-focused staff. Holds an active Secret security clearance.

Systems

- Orchestrated modernization of NASA library systems—replacing Symphony with Alma/Primo, consolidating ILLiad subscriptions, retiring discovery tools, and launching LibApps, OpenAthens, and a WordPress site—coordinating timelines with leadership, library staff, vendors, developers, and cybersecurity.
- Led a multiyear initiative to align ten NASA center libraries under a unified “one NASA library” service model, standardizing policies, workflows, and user support for a single, coherent researcher experience.
- Analyzed overlapping systems and contracts, drafted cost tables and timelines, and developed a simplified applications stack that enabled the retirement of redundant platforms, reducing annual costs by \$1.7M.
- Administered NASA's SirsiDynix Symphony ILS, ILLiad, and Springshare LibAnswers/LibGuides platforms and led agency-wide working groups to standardize policies and workflows across centers.
- Served as primary point of contact with Ex Libris, SirsiDynix, OCLC, Springshare, and OpenAthens, coordinating requirements, demos, configurations, upgrades, and issue escalation across centers.
- Developed NASA's enterprise LibAnswers site, building service queues, widgets, and center-specific FAQ repositories; configuring staff permissions and auto-routing; authoring 30+ FAQs; creating rollout marketing graphics; and refining the site based on user feedback.

Design

- Led end-to-end design of the NASA Langley Library's WordPress site and informational brochure, structuring content around user tasks to provide a clear, modern entry point to library services and resources.
- Designed and edited NASA Libraries' biannual magazine, shaping themes, coordinating contributors, conducting interviews, and delivering print and digital issues for agency-wide outreach and engagement.
- Built an AI Reference Guide, collaborating on content and using layout and UX patterns to present diverse AI resources in a digestible, user-centered interface for NASA's research community.
- Recreated a 1969 Langley Apollo 11 newsletter from surviving print copies, producing a digital edition and fresh print run used as a legacy replica at Apollo anniversary events.
- Created the narrative graphic “Snapshots of the Past,” blending archival research, typography, and source references; published in NASA History News & Notes (Vol. 39, Issue 2).

Reference

- Developed a specialized catalog and controlled vocabulary for 125 Mobile Acoustics Facility flight test reports, indexing 12 countries, 30 programs, and 150+ organizations.
- Led a 16mm film digitization initiative, coordinating metadata export and cleanup for 2,500+ digitized files, planning repository ingest workflows, and improving preservation and discoverability of archival films.
- Provided research and information services for scientists, engineers, and mission staff, connecting them with technical standards, journal literature, and NASA technical reports using enterprise discovery and access tools.

Loyola University Chicago

Cudahy Library
Circulation Intern

2017-2018

Chicago, IL

- Supported circulation desk operations, assisting patrons with transactions and basic reference services.
- Managed weekend operations, supervising student workers, and opening and closing the library.

Northwestern University

Joseph Shaffner Library
Reference Intern

2016-2018

Chicago, IL

- Provided reference and information services for the Kellogg School of Management, School of Professional Studies, and the Osher Lifelong Learning Institute.
- Delivered in-person and online instruction and supported computer lab use, assisting with internet access, troubleshooting, and research skills development.

Chicago Public Library

Harold Washington Library Center
Maker Lab Specialist

2016-2018

Chicago, IL

- Conducted workshops and instruction in open-source design software, 3D printing, laser cutting, and CNC routing, enabling community members to create and prototype projects.
- Maintained lab equipment, provided tours, and facilitated public access to digital fabrication tools in the Maker Lab, ensuring safe, welcoming access while fostering community engagement and creative skill development.

United States Marine Corps

2nd Battalion, 24th Marines
Data Network Specialist (E-5)

2006-2012

Chicago, IL

- Managed technology systems and equipment for military operations, supporting secure communications and information networks during deployment.
- Developed an Excel-based inventory system tracking \$3M+ in Department of Defense technology assets in support of Operation Iraqi Freedom missions.

EDUCATION**University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign**

Master of Library & Information Science (MLIS)

2019

Champaign, IL

Purdue University

Bachelor of Science (BS), Aviation Technology

2013

West Lafayette, IN

United States Marine Corps

Marine Corps Communication-Electronics School

2007

Twentynine Palms, CA

SKILLS

- **Professional:** Project coordination; vendor relations; marketing; process improvement; team facilitation
- **Systems & Platforms:** Ex Libris 360, Alma; OCLC ILLiad; SirsiDynix Symphony; OpenAthens
- **Applications:** Ex Libris Primo VE, Summon; Springshare LibAnswers, LibGuides; OCLC WorldCat Discovery
- **Web & Code:** HTML, CSS, Visual Studio Code, Figma, WordPress, Notepad++
- **Design & Fabrication:** Adobe InDesign, Illustrator, Photoshop; 3D design/printing; electronic & laser cutting